

Hazardous Material Spill and Chemical Exposure

Policy Number	POL-EH-014	Owner / Department	Environmental Health & Safety
Effective Date	2023-12-01	Version	2.1
Last Revised	2026-02-18	Next Review	2028-02-18
Approved By	Environmental Health & Safety Committee	Applies To	All staff handling hazardous drugs, chemicals, or compressed gases

1. Purpose

To protect staff, patients, and the environment during hazardous material spills and chemical exposures, consistent with the OSHA Hazard Communication Standard (29 CFR 1910.1200) and USP <800> for hazardous drugs.

2. Immediate Response

1. Protect yourself and others; evacuate the immediate area if the spill is large, volatile, or unknown.
2. For a large or hazardous spill, call a Code Orange and notify EH&S; do not attempt cleanup beyond your training or without the correct PPE.
3. Consult the Safety Data Sheet (SDS) for the specific agent before cleanup; use the spill kit appropriate to the hazard class.
4. For skin/eye exposure, flush the affected area with water for at least 15 minutes and report to Employee Health or the ED.
5. File an event report per POL-RM-013.

IMPORTANT — A chemical exposure causing injury, or any hazardous-drug spill reaching a patient, is at least SEV-2. Escalate immediately for respiratory symptoms, large volatile spills, or unknown agents.

3. References

- OSHA Hazard Communication Standard, 29 CFR 1910.1200.
- USP General Chapter <800> — Hazardous Drugs Handling in Healthcare Settings.
- Related: POL-EH-001, POL-RM-013.